

1.2.5 – 1.2.7 Waterfall vs Agile: Comparison and Case Studies

وائرفال ماڈل سخت (Rigid) ہے، گاؤک صرف شروع اور آخر ميں شامل ہوتا ہے، سافٹ ويئر ايک ہی بار آخر ميں ملتا ہے اور...

CS XI

Chapter 1: Computer Systems

Lecture 18 of 20

1.2.5 – 1.2.7 Waterfall vs Agile: Comparison and Case Studies

LEARN IT

Both models follow the same SDLC phases. The difference is **how** they move through them: Waterfall goes through each phase **once**, in a straight line; Agile goes through all phases **many times**, in small loops.

Dimension	Waterfall model	Agile model
Flexibility	Rigid. Hard to make changes later.	Very flexible. Adapts to changes easily in the next sprint.
Customer involvement	Only at the start (requirements) and the end (delivery).	Continuous throughout the project (after every sprint).
Delivery of software	Single delivery at the very end.	Frequent, partial deliveries after every sprint.
Testing	Done late, in a dedicated testing phase.	Continuous testing within every sprint.
Documentation	Heavy documentation required.	Light documentation. Focus is on working software.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Choosing a model — think like the textbook.

Case A: Al-Noor Library Management System. Requirements fixed 100% before coding → no changes expected → **Waterfall**.

Case B: Al-Noor Student Mobile Application. Teachers, parents and students keep asking for features → requirements change → **Agile**.

Practice case: A bank wants a salary-calculation program for a fixed government formula that will not change. Requirements are clear and fixed, the project is medium-sized, and the technology is stable → **Waterfall**.

Practice case: A start-up wants a new food-delivery app and is not sure which features customers will like. Requirements are unclear and the project is innovative → **Agile**.

REMEMBER IT

One question decides it: **"Will the requirements change?"** No → Waterfall. Yes / not sure → Agile.

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not say one model is always "better". Each suits a different situation. In exams, justify your choice using the project's features (fixed vs changing requirements, size, customer involvement).

وائرفال ماڈل سخت (Rigid) ہے، گاہک صرف شروع اور آخر میں شامل ہوتا ہے، سافٹ ویئر ایک ہی بار آخر میں ملتا ہے اور دستاویزات زیادہ ہوتی ہیں۔ ایجائل ماڈل لچکدار ہے، گاہک ہر اسپرنٹ کے بعد شامل ہوتا ہے، سافٹ ویئر بار بار حصوں میں ملتا ہے اور ٹیسٹنگ مسلسل ہوتی ہے۔ اگر ضروریات طے شدہ ہوں تو وائرفال اور اگر بدلتی رہیں تو ایجائل منتخب کریں۔

CHECK YOURSELF

1. In which model is the customer involved only at the start and the end?
2. Which model delivers software in frequent, partial deliveries?
3. A school wants an exam-result system with rules that never change. Which model?

Answers: 1. Waterfall. 2. Agile. 3. Waterfall (fixed, clear requirements).

Next lecture: 1.3.1 – 1.3.4 Communication Models and the OSI 7-Layer Model